OFFICIAL GUIDELINES FOR PRE-IDEATHON

DATE: AUG 21ST 2026.

1. Objective of PRE-IDEATHON

- PRE-IDEATHON 2026 is designed to provide students with a platform to identify genuine real-world problems, develop innovative solutions, evaluate their feasibility, and present them as potential ventures.
- The competition will focus not only on how innovative an idea is, but also on whether the idea can realistically be implemented, converted into a sustainable business, generate revenue, and create measurable impact.
- Participants are therefore encouraged to think beyond an idea and demonstrate a clear pathway:
- Problem → Solution → Validation → Implementation → Market → Revenue → Growth

2. Eligibility & Team Formation

- A team may consist of 1 to 4 members and team consisting of 4 members must include at least one female member.
- Participants may participate with their own original idea.
- The idea should address a genuine problem, unmet need, inefficiency, or opportunity.
- A participant should not be a member of more than one team for the same PRE-IDEATHON.
- Each team must nominate one Team Leader.
- The Team Leader will be responsible for representing the team whenever required.
- All team members are expected serve a vital role in team.
- Changes in team composition after registration will require approval from the organizing committee.

3. Idea/Problem Statement

- Teams will Select an problem statement or Propose their own problem and solution.
- Teams should clearly explain:

What is the problem?

Who faces the problem?

How serious/frequent is it?

What existing solutions are available?

Why are existing solutions insufficient?

- Ideas that merely identify a problem without proposing a meaningful solution may receive lower evaluation scores.

4. Originality & Intellectual Property

- The proposed idea must be the team's own work.
- Plagiarism, copying, or unauthorized use of another team's idea will not be permitted.
- Existing technologies or business models may be used as inspiration, but teams must demonstrate meaningful innovation, differentiation, or improvement.
- If an existing product/service is being improved, the team must clearly explain:

What already exists?

What is being changed?

Why is the proposed version better?

- The organizers will not claim ownership of participants' ideas unless separately agreed through an official written process.

5. Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

- AI tools may be used for assistance in areas such as:
- Brainstorming, Research assistance, Language improvement, Presentation design, Data organization, Preliminary analysis.
- However the core idea, reasoning, validation, business logic, and pitch must represent the team's own understanding and work.
- Teams must be able to explain every major aspect of their proposal during Q&A.
- Using AI to fabricate research, customer data, financial figures, testimonials, or other evidence is prohibited.

6. Event Format & Time Limit

- Each team will receive approximately:

4-5 minutes – Idea Presentation

3-5 minutes – Judges' Q&A

- Teams must complete their pitch within the allotted time.
- No additional time will normally be provided unless an official technical issue affecting the event.

7. Presentation Requirements

- Each team should prepare a 6–8 slide PPT presentation.
- The presentation should preferably cover: Problem statement, Target users, Proposed solution, How it works, Key features, Innovation & Differentiation, USP, Existing alternatives, Implementation & Business Model roadmap, Required resources/technology, Target market, Revenue model, unit economics, Impact & Future Growth strategy.
- Teams may modify the structure according to their idea, provided that the essential aspects are covered.
- Since PRE-IDEATHON focuses on ideas with potential to become real ventures, teams should demonstrate a realistic implementation pathway.
- A strong idea without a realistic implementation pathway may receive a lower score under the implementation criterion.

8. Business & Revenue Potential

- Business potential will be a major component of evaluation.
- Teams should demonstrate how their solution can potentially become financially sustainable.
- Teams should explain:

Who will pay for the solution?

Is the market local, regional, national, or global?

Revenue Model

- Examples may include: Direct product sales, Subscription, Commission, Licensing, Freemium, Service fees, B2B contracts, Marketplace model, Advertising, Pay-per-use, Pricing
- Teams should have a basic understanding of:
- Production/development, Customer acquisition, Distribution
- Maintenance and Other major costs Profitability.
- Important: Exact financial projections are not compulsory at the PRE-IDEATHON stage. However, assumptions should be logical, realistic, and defensible.

9. Evaluation Criteria – 100 Marks

Sr. no	Criteria	Marks
1	Problem Understanding & Relevance	10
2	Innovation & Originality	15
3	Feasibility & Technical Approach	10
4	Social Impact	10
5	Creativity & Unique Selling Proposition (USP)	15
6	Revenue, Business Potential and Scalability	25
7	Presentation & Q&A	15
	Total	100

10. Disqualification

- A team may be disqualified for:

Plagiarism or copyright violation.

Submission of false or fabricated information.

Misconduct or inappropriate behaviour.

Use of unauthorized assistance during the competition.

Failure to comply with official event instructions.

Failure to complete mandatory official Eureka registration.

Providing incorrect or misleading participant information.

- Any activity that compromises the fairness or integrity of the competition.
- The decision regarding disqualification will rest with the organizing committee.

11. Attendance & Event Discipline

- Participants should report/join before the scheduled start time.
- Participants should remain available throughout the event.
- Participants should preferably join 10–15 minutes before the event.
- Participants are expected to maintain professional conduct.
- Any disruptive, abusive, discriminatory, or inappropriate behaviour may lead to removal from the event.
- Participants must follow instructions given by the organizing team, coordinators, and judges.
- In case two or more teams receive the same final score, priority will be given in the following order:

i. Innovation & Originality
ii. Revenue, Business and Implementation Potential.

- The final decision of the jury/panel will be final and binding.

12. Event Outcome & Opportunities

- Based on the competition announcement:
- Top 3 Winning Teams can get an opportunity to visit IIT Bombay, Delhi, Bengaluru, and other locations through the Eureka! ecosystem.
- Top 10 Teams will directly confirm their seats in the Main IDEATHON.
- Top 5 Best Ideas will receive free mentorship by IIEC till revenue creation.
- E-Certificates will be provided to participants.
- Participants can get an opportunity to interact with industry specialists.

FOR ANY QUERY REGARDING GUIDELINES CONTACT EVENT AND OPERATIONS HEAD JANGID SANJEEV: 9834360801